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Institutional Email Account Usage Guidelines: 2024

These guidelines are to be known as "Institutional Email Account Usage Guidelines" and will be applicable on each employee or student who requests and/or possess an Institutional Email Account. These guidelines will be in force from the date of publication by the signature of the Principal. However, it may be applicable in cases of misuses and violations regardless the date of such event.

1. Institute Property

Email and related services are extended for the sole use of Institute faculty, staff, students, and other appropriately authorized users to accomplish tasks related to and consistent with the mission of the Institute. These services are privileges extended to enhance the performance of Institute and shall not be claimed as right. Institute email systems and services are Institute facilities, resources, and property. Any email address or account assigned by the Institute to individuals, sub-units, or functions of the Institute is the property of the Institute.

2. Indemnification of the Institute

Users agree by virtue of access to the Institute computing and email systems, to indemnify, defend, and hold harmless the Institute for any suits, claims, losses, expenses, or damages, including but not limited to litigation costs and attorney's fees, arising from or related to the user's access to or use of Institute email and computing systems, services, and facilities.

3. Authorized Service Restrictions

1. Users are allowed to use their institutional email for work-related / academic purposes only.
2. Email users are required to comply with Gujarat State and Central laws, Institute policies as applicable, and general standards of professional and personal courtesy and conduct (be aware of these on regular basis). Access to Institute email services is a privilege that may be wholly or partially restricted by the Institute without prior notice and without the consent of the email user:
    a) When required by and consistent with applicable law or guidelines;
    b) When there is a reasonable suspicion that violations of guidelines or law have occurred or may occur;
    c) When required to meet time-dependent, critical operational needs.

Such access restrictions are subject to the approval of the appropriate Institute supervisory or management authority (e.g., Principal, Department Heads etc.).

3. Institute may define additional "Conditions of Appropriate Use for Local Computing and Network Facilities" to supplement this with additional detail, guidelines, or restrictions. Such conditions must be consistent with this guidelines, and are intended to deal primarily with situations of limited resource supply and security.
4. When an individual's affiliation with the Institute ends for reasons other than becoming Emeritus Faculty, the individual's Institute official email services will be discontinued.
5. The Institute may permit the inspection, monitoring, or disclosure of emails when:
    a. Required by or consistent with applicable laws or guidelines or any appropriately issued subpoena / court order or institutional inquiry;
    b. There is a reasonable suspicion that violations of law or Institute guidelines have occurred or may occur;
    c. There are time-dependent, critical operational needs of Institute business if the Institute determines that the information sought is not more readily available by other means.
5. In such instances, the Institute will, as a courtesy, try to inform email users prior to any inspection, monitoring, or disclosure of email records, except when such notification would be detrimental to an investigation of possible violation of law or Institute guidelines.
6. Users are required to comply with Institute requests for access to and copies of email records when access or disclosure is required or allowed by applicable laws or guidelines, regardless whether such records reside on a computer housed or owned by the Institute. Failure to comply with such requests can lead to disciplinary or other legal actions pursuant to applicable law or guidelines, including but not limited to appropriate Institute personnel policies or Codes of Conduct.

4. Misuse

1. Using email for illegal activities is strictly prohibited. Illegal use may include, but is not limited to, obscenity; pornography; threats; harassment; theft; attempting unauthorized access to data or attempting to breach any security measures on any electronic communications system; attempting to intercept any electronic communication transmissions without proper authority; and violation of copyright, trademark, or defamation law.
2. Creation or transmission of material that is abusive or threatening to others or serves to harass others is prohibited.
3. Creation or transmission of anonymous messages or deliberately forging messages or email header information, (i.e. without clear identification of the sender) is prohibited.
4. Failure to follow Gujarat State and Central laws with regard to the disposition of email records may lead to criminal charges. Theft or unauthorized destruction, mutilation, defacement, alteration, falsification, removal, or secretion of email records may lead to appropriate charges.
5. Use of any Institute facility shall not be of a nature that competes with the Institute in business by favouring or helping other Institutes / Universities. Thus, usage of Institute's resources shall not be connected with any use or application that conflicts with employee's obligations to the Institute as their employer.
6. In addition to illegal activities, the following email practices are expressly prohibited: entry, examination, use, transfer, and tampering with the accounts and files of others, altering email

system software or hardware configurations; or interfering with the work of others or with Institute or other computing facilities.

7. If a user is requested by another user via email or in writing to refrain from sending email messages, the recipient is prohibited from sending that user any further email messages until such time as they have been notified by the Administrator that such correspondence is permissible. Failure to honour such a request shall be deemed a violation of this Guidelines. This provision does not apply to email messages required for the performance of job duties by appropriate authorities.
8. Institute email services may not be used for commercial activities, personal financial gains; personal uses other than formal Institute duties, uses that violate other Institute policies or guidelines; or uses inconsistent with applicable Gujarat State or Central laws.
9. Use of any text, data or communications which is generated by any tool using a full / partial use of AI is strongly prohibited.
10. Email users shall not give the impression that they are representing, giving opinions, or otherwise making statements on behalf of the Institute or any unit of the Institute unless expressly authorized to do so. Where appropriate, the following explicit disclaimer shall be included: "The opinions or statements expressed herein are my own and should not be taken as a position, opinion, or endorsement of the Institute."
11. Institute email account and all services related to it must not be linked with or used for the purpose of registration with any social media or any online services which are not of academic nature to the concerned subject of the user. Violation of this guideline will result in punitive action by Institute.
12. Services related to email account shall not be used in a manner that interfere with the email user's employment or other obligations to the Institute.
13. Unauthorised transmission to a third party of confidential material concerning the activities of the Institute or user credentials in any manner is prohibited and will draw appropriate action.
14. Email messages and other data arising from personal use shall be subject to access consistent with this Guidelines or applicable law. Student accounts will be liable to frequent and regular audits and logs of their activities will be kept. Accordingly, personal use does not carry with it a reasonable expectation of privacy.
15. Institute email services shall not be used for purposes that could reasonably be expected to cause, directly or indirectly, strain on any computing facilities or interference with others' use of email or email systems. Such uses include, but are not limited to, the use of email services to:
    a. Send or forward chain letters;
    b. "Spam"; that is, to exploit email lists or similar systems for the widespread distribution of unsolicited mail;
    c. "Letter-bomb"; that is, to resend the same email repeatedly to one or more recipients.

5. Confidentiality

1. The confidentiality of email cannot be assured, and any confidentiality may be compromised by access consistent with applicable law or guidelines, including this guidelines, by unintended redistribution, or due to current technologies inadequate to protect against unauthorized access. Users, therefore, should exercise extreme caution in using email to communicate confidential or sensitive matters, and should not assume that their email is completely private or confidential.

2. Users may not access, use, or disclose personal or confidential information without appropriate authorization, and must take necessary precautions to protect confidentiality of personal or confidential information, regardless whether the information is maintained on paper or is found in email or other electronic records.
3. The Institutional office may elect to publish student email addresses for official uses like Placements, Directory, and Alumni Association etc.

6. Security and Preservation

1. Email users and operators must follow sound professional practices in providing for the security of email records, data, applications programs, and systems programs under their jurisdiction.
2. Users are responsible for safeguarding their ID and password, and for using them only as authorized. Email is often the medium of hacker attacks, confidentiality breaches, viruses and other malware. These issues can compromise legality and security of the Institute. Thus, users must:
    a. Select strong password with at least eight characters (capital and lower-case letters, symbols and numbers) without using personal information (e.g. birthdays);
    b. Remember password instead of writing them down and keep them secret;
    c. Change their email password every three months.
3. Users and operators must guard against storage media deterioration and email record inaccessibility due to hardware or software obsolescence. To eliminate these situations, users must make provision for future accessibility by:
        a. migrating all official email records to the next generation of hardware or software; or
        b. migrating only current official email records to new hardware or software, or converting official email records not migrated to other media (e.g., optical disk, COM) for short-term storage or to "eye readable form" (i.e., paper) for long term storage and preservation.
4. It is mandatory that users enable and use 2-step Verification in the settings of their account.
5. Each user is responsible for all email transactions made under the authorization of their ID, and for all network email activity originating from their data jack. Use of email user identifications for commercial purposes is prohibited. Access to user identifications shall not be shared, loaned or sold.
6. Automatic forwarding or redirection of emails to Institute's or other mail domains is strictly prohibited.
7. Remote access to Institute emails is possible through internet. Remote access using POP3 or IMAP mailboxes off campus is permitted via secure methods only like using S/MIME (Secure/Multipurpose Internet Mail Extensions) protocol.
8. Use of VPN for institutional email and related services is not permitted without prior approval of Administrator.
9. Creating and using Email Lists is permissible with prior permission of Administrator.

7. Violations

Suspected or known misuses and violations of this guidelines, or law should be confidentially reported to the Principal. Violations will be processed by the appropriate Institute authorities and/or law enforcement agencies. Violations may result in revocation of email service privileges; academic dishonesty or Code

of Conduct proceedings; faculty, staff, or student disciplinary action up to and including dismissal; referral to law enforcement agencies; or other legal action.

8. Statements of Responsibilities

1. Individual users are responsible for their own actions. The use of email facilities by individuals at the Institute of assumes and implies compliance with this guidelines, without exception. Every user of email systems has a duty to ensure they practice appropriate and proper use and must understand their responsibilities in this regard.
2. Principal will be responsible for ensuring all staff including Heads of Departments are aware of this guidelines; Heads in turn will be responsible for informing their students of this guidelines (whenever applicable). An acknowledgement is to be obtained from students by Heads declaring their awareness and pledge to comply with these guidelines (whenever applicable). Head of respective departments will have a degree of culpability in case of violation of this policy by their students.
3. Google Workspace Administrator of Institute will be responsible for the creation and suspension of Email accounts as per requests directed to him. He will also be responsible for the troubleshooting of individual account operations and centrally configuring security and other settings.
4. Any request for the creation of Email account should come from Office Superintendent (in case of employees), from Head of Department (in case of PG students) and from Chairman, F-DC (in case of research students) to the Administrator.
5. Office Superintendent shall be responsible to convey discontinuation of student's and employee's affiliation to Institute on temporary or permanent basis to the Administrator for the purpose of suspension of account usage.

9. Quotas and Limits

1. Accounts that are removed will have their files archived, unless specifically requested and approved.
2. All accounts have quota limits placed on them. Users will receive email notification when approaching their quota limit and are encouraged to follow guidance in notification email to manage their account. Once over quota no further email can be delivered to an individual's inbox until they have reduced their storage below their limit.
3. There are limits on the size of an email that can be received and transmitted.

10. Virus checking

1. Computer viruses, Trojan horses and worms are collectively known as malware. One common method of distributing malware is via email.
2. All email communication is to be checked for malware. Checking strategies include: refusing messages containing executable attachments (most common but not limited to .exe, .apk, .dmg, .app, .vb etc.) and scanning messages for known malware or a combination of both techniques.
3. Users are strongly discouraged to share and forward any unnecessary files to restrict the spread of malware.
4. Users are advised to be aware of Phishing emails and avoid opening attachments and clicking on links when content is not adequately explained (e.g. "Download this free book now."). Users shall be suspicious of clickbait titles. Users shall check email and names of unknown senders to

ensure they are legitimate. Users shall look for inconsistencies or style red flags (e.g. grammar mistakes, capital letters, excessive number of exclamation marks etc.).

5. Users are supposed to keep their anti-malware programs subscribed, renewed and updated.

Email Signature

1. Users are encouraged to create an email signature that is professional and represents institute well. Only Permanent employees may include Institute's logo in their Signature. In any case, Signature must not look childish or casual. Following is a template of an acceptable email signature:

[Student Name]:

[Program Name]:

[Semester and Division]:

[Enrolment No.]:

[Phone number]

[Email Id]:

[Student Signature]

Recommended by: Date: _____

HOD

Approved by: Date: _____

Principal